

THE GEEK'S GUIDE TO MANAGING MONEY USING TECH

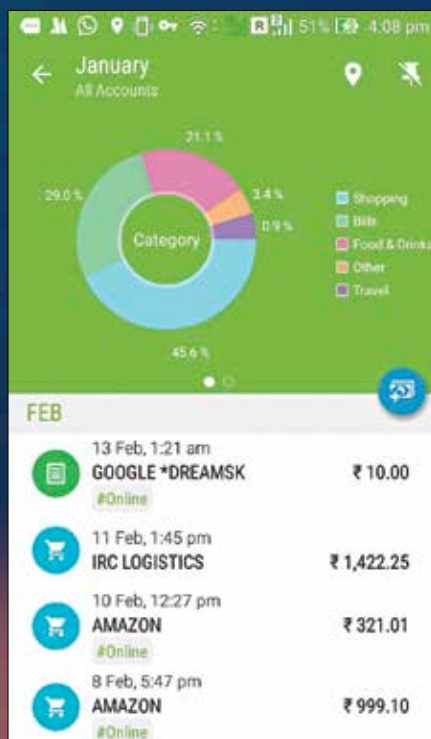
An assortment of apps and web tools that promise to take on the role of your personal accountant, investment manager and much more

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It is that time of the year again. The taxman is almost knocking at the door and your workplace is biting its nails for the increments to come. Your head bursts trying to keep track of your income, expenses and investments over the past month and year. Even if you're not the type who needs any assistance with numbers, having your expenditure and bills automatically tracked and reminded, never really made anyone's life harder. That is exactly what a host of services in the form of smartphone apps and websites are offering you now, with little or no effort from your side. We went through a bunch of them and here are the ones we found useful.

1 Walnut: Broadly an expense and budget tracker with SMS analysis capabilities, it has a category analysis feature and also, groups your transactions accordingly. In the analytics area, you will get compiled pie-charts of expenses of each time period, grouped into categories, as well as rankings. Some features which distinguish it are the ability to enter comments for each transaction, attach pictures of bills to each transaction, and to read the SMS from within the app. It can additionally detect online transactions separately and highlight them. Also, the notifications are amazingly useful, showing you the percentage of spending left in each category.

If you are looking for more detail in the automatic categorisation and would like more comprehensive analytics that lets you compare specific categories across months, WealthPack is a similar and better SMS analysis based app. Walnut: <http://dgit.in/WalnutXpense>
WealthPack: <http://dgit.in/WealthPk>



Walnut does an excellent job of showing you the big picture across months as well as a detailed breakdown of each month

2 Zoho: This one isn't an SMS expense tracker. You have to manually enter and categorise your expenses then enter the merchants in Zoho expense tracker. Then why is it even here? It has a report oriented approach which lets you generate reports for entire trips or certain days with an option to mark each transaction to be claimed as reimbursement. A very useful feature is the app's ability to scan a receipt and retrieve the data from it. Link: <http://dgit.in/ZohoXpense>

3 Expense Manager: Even though the UI on this app is not as friendly as the other alternatives, the overall approach is very professional. You have to enter data and modify categories manually but there's no automatic detection. The graphs and charts this app can generate are at par with professional options with charts classified by category, subcategory, time period, etc. You can also mark payments as cleared or uncleared, attach pictures and define the payee in each payment. If you are looking for a powerful tool and don't want the app to auto-detect stuff, this is totally what you should go for. Expense Manager: <http://dgit.in/ExpenseMgr>

4 MoneyLover: Out of all the apps we tested, MoneyLover has the most persistent notification settings that we could find. It constantly shows you the current amount of money you are left with on